



\$13,000 iMac Pro

If you include Intel's massive non-gaming 18-core Xeon W processor, you're looking at more than \$13,000 iMac Pro <http://digit.in/iMacPro13K>



Essential 360 livestreaming

The 0.1.093.003 update for the Essential Camera app brings official support for livestreaming on YouTube. <http://digit.in/EP360Strm>

LG V30 Plus

Excellence interrupted

When you pull the LG V30+ out of its box, you instantly fall in love with it. Seriously, over the first few minutes, hours or more, you won't think about any other smartphone, and we include the iPhone X and Galaxy Note 8 there. But then, over the next few hours or days, you start finding out flaws in the device. And that's why the LG V30+, like many of LG's phones in yester-years, is excellence interrupted.

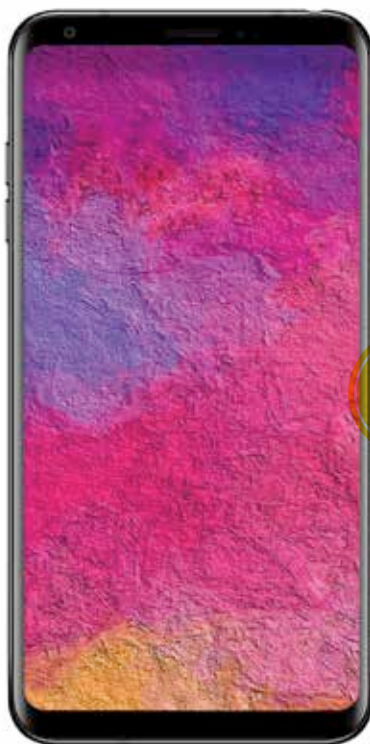
Build and Design

For the most part, you will love the LG V30+ for its design. Its metallic frame feels absolutely sturdy, while the glass back somehow refuses to slip out of your hand. It's certainly a finger-print magnet, but LG's design is such that your palm never really touches it. At 158 grams, the phone is also incredibly light, something you wouldn't expect if you've seen the metal-glass designs on its competitors.

It has a 6-inch screen, but my not-so-large hands tend to reach the other side of the screen quite easily. To be clear, it's not perfectly suited for single-handed usage, but it's certainly one of the closest. Of course, the 18:9 display makes that possible, but despite its tall display, the V30+ doesn't actually look narrow. In your hand, the phone is immersive, natural, solid, and simple yet beautiful.

Performance

LG's software is slow and that's a big problem. The phone posts the high scores on benchmarks, but its software is prone to lags. The animations are slow by default, but you will also notice some slight lags when opening apps, scrolling through menus and so on. That doesn't mean the phone is slow per se, it's just a stark contrast to



Price
₹44,990



FEATURE.....	76
PERFORMANCE.....	88
VALUE.....	50
DESIGN.....	87

phones like the OnePlus 5T and Google Pixel 2 XL. Stock Android phone lovers have nothing to like here, and those who want custom UIs will make a better choice with Samsung's work.

Audio

With headphones on, the built-in DAC takes over the audio responsibilities, delivering very tight bass and clear audio. It's excellent for audiophiles, but most others may never feel the difference. With high-quality tracks and good headphones, there's nothing that beats the LG V30+ out on the market today. Listening to the same track on this and the Google Pixel 2 XL, using the Audiotechnica CK-X9, it was very easy to get immersed in the V30's obvious superiority.

Camera

You can still work with the performance of this phone or its display, but the ultimate deal breaker here is the camera. It's an impressive spec, with f/1.6 lenses and a secondary true-wide

angle camera. Yet, LG chose to include a 1-micron sensor underneath the lens, which keeps you from taking advantage of the large aperture here.

LG's camera also comes with some useful modes. The Cine Video mode allows you to zoom into specific parts of the video, unlike other phones that zoom into the centre.

There's a Snap Shot mode that shows splits the viewfinder into two halves. It shows a preview of the photo you just clicked in the bottom half, but it takes longer to process images.

The Guide Shot mode lets you choose a sample image and tries to bring images as close to that as possible, while the Food mode is meant specifically for food shot. You can shoot three-second gif-like videos using the Snap Movie mode.

In terms of battery life, the V30 is actually amongst the most dependable flagships today. It lasts for over 11 hours on the PCMark Work 2.0 battery test, which is amongst the highest we have seen in this range. On regular use, it lasted a full day quite easily. In fact, using the phone as my primary, it lasted 12-14 hours quite easily, on regular usage.

Conclusion

The LG V30+ is a strong flagship, perhaps the strongest LG has made so far, but it LG made some poor choices here. The V30+ is the best phone I wouldn't recommend you buy. It needs a better camera, much better software and a more dependable display. LG has the design right, but it's just not the right flagship for 2017. That said, this is a phone audiophile should definitely consider.

—Prasid Banerjee

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Snapdragon 835 | GPU: Adreno 540 | OS: Android 7.1.2 (Nougat) | CARD SLOT: microSD (up to 256 GB) | SIZE: 6.0 inches | RESOLUTION: 1440 x 2880 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: 16 MP (f/1.6, 1 µm, OIS) + 13 MP (f/1.9, no AF) | CAMERA SECONDARY: 5 MP (f/2.2, 1.12 µm).

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